



LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL MINUTES

Monday, July 6, 2026

City of Lakewood

6000 Main Street SW

Lakewood, WA 98499

<https://www.youtube.com/user/cityoflakewoodwa>

Telephone via Zoom: +1(253) 215-8782

Participant ID: 868 7263 2373

CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Bocchi called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 4 – Mayor Paul Bocchi, Deputy Mayor Patti Belle, Councilmembers Michael Brandstetter and Ryan Pearson.

Councilmembers Excused: 3 – Councilmembers J. Trestin Lauricella, Philip Lindholm and Ellen Talbo.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mayor Bocchi led the Pledge of Allegiance.

PROCLAMATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

None.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

Corey Campbell, Classy Chassis, spoke in opposition to the street closures for the Custer Road Transportation Improvement Project due to impacts to the business.

Corey Campbell, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of a revised plan for the Custer Road Transportation Improvement Project to protect businesses.

Nancy Flajole, Best Burgers, spoke about the Custer Road Transportation Improvement Project, impacts to the business and lack of communication.

Abid Rahmani, Discount Liquidation Lakewood, spoke about the business licensing and occupancy permit process and lack of responses from the City.

Collin Campbell, Classy Chassis, spoke about the Custer Road Transportation Improvement Project, impacts to the business and lack of communication.

John Ram, Classy Chassis, spoke about the rebuilding of the business following a fire and the Custer Road Transportation Improvement Project road closure and its impact on employees.

Ethan Baydo, Classy Chassis, spoke about impacts to the business from road closures for Custer Road Transportation Improvement Project and in support of better access and mitigation.

Kailyn Mills, Classic Coffee, spoke about impacts to the business from the road closure for the Custer Road Transportation Improvement Project.

Lisa O’Gorman, 7614 Custer Road, spoke about impacts on her property and business from the road closure for the Custer Road Transportation Improvement Project and potential parking violations.

Karen Hertzog, Lakewood resident, spoke about removal of a tree on Lake Steilacoom Drive and requested autopsies of trees when the Arborist Report does not recommend tree removal.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, spoke about the removal of a Douglas Fir tree on Lake Steilacoom Drive, the City’s decision-making process related to Arborist recommendations and in support of the City adhering to the tree code revisions and following Arborist recommendations.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood resident, in support of an independent audit of city operations and about expert recommendations not being followed for tree protections.

Hailey Ivey, spoke about tree canopy, pavement and in support of protection of the environment.

James Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke about the National Environment and Climate Change Task Force and its focus on heat mitigation when action is being taken by the City to increase heat.

Hayden Holster, Clean Paws and Pals, spoke about impacts to his business from road closures for the Custer Road Transportation Improvement Project and in support of mitigation.

Paul Brice, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of allowing retail cannabis sales in the City.

Ebrahim Mirjalili, Lakewood resident, spoke about attending a World Cup game in Seattle and requested that the minutes of June 15 be corrected to reflect his comments.

Judith Anderson, spoke in opposition to the cutting of trees in Lakewood.

Ken Paulson, expressed concerns about the 25 mile per hour speed limit on Lochburn Lane.

Amber Sanchez, Classy Chassis, spoke about the impacts to business advertising, marketing campaigns and customer relationships from the Custer Road Transportation Improvement Project.

C O N S E N T A G E N D A

- A. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of June 8, 2026.
- B. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of June 15, 2026.
- C. Approval of claims vouchers, in the amount of \$2,858,724.11, for the period of May 16, 2026 through June 15, 2026.
- D. Approval of payroll checks, in the amount of \$3,209,791.66, for the period of May 16, 2026 through June 15, 2026.
- E. Motion No. 2026-47

Authorizing the execution of an interagency agreement with the Washington Traffic Safety Commission, in the amount of \$115,485, for the Regional Phlebotomy Program.

F. Motion No. 2026-48

Authorizing the execution of a HOME agreement with Tacoma-Pierce County Habitat for Humanity, in the amount of \$180,000, for down payment assistance to be provided to low-income homebuyers at American Lake Townhomes affordable housing project.

G. Motion No. 2026-49

Accepting a SPAR grant from the Washington State Office of Public Defense in the amount of \$32,500, for Indigent Defense costs for Simple Possession or Public Use of Controlled Substances.

H. Items filed in the Office of the City Clerk:

1. Parks and Recreation Advisory Board meeting minutes of March 24, 2026.
2. Planning Commission meeting minutes of May 6, 2026.
3. Planning Commission meeting minutes of June 3, 2026.

Councilmember Brandstetter requested Item No. E, Motion No. 2026-47 be removed from the Consent Agenda.

COUNCILMEMER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT THE CONSENT AGENDA MINUS ITEM NO. E. SECONDED BY DEPUTY MAYOR BELLE. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER MOVED TO ADOPT MOTION NO. 2026-47. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

R E G U L A R A G E N D A

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

None.

REPORTS BY THE CITY MANAGER

City Manager Russell shared that the Farmers Market and Summer Concert Series will be held on July 7, the Downtown Neighborhood Association meeting will be held on July 8, the Lake City Neighborhood Association will be held on July 9.

He shared that the Planning Commission will receive an overview of cannabis regulations and he requested that the City Council provide feedback regarding dates for scheduling of a meeting to discuss the 2027 Legislative Agenda and Policy Manual.

Troy Potswinski, Capital Projects Manager, provided an overview of the Custer Road Improvement Project, the impact to businesses, public communications and timeline for the project.

CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Pearson shared that he attended the Pierce County Sewer Review Committee meeting noting that he will Chair the Committee. He shared that he attended the Parks and Recreation Advisory Board meeting and spoke about options for parking at parks and expressed his appreciation for the effort related to the West Coast Baseball League proposal.

Councilmember Brandstetter shared that he was in favor of a discussion about the Custer Road Improvement Project during next week's Council Comments portion of the agenda. He spoke about firework use throughout the community and shared that he will attend the Lake City Neighborhood Association meeting.

Deputy Mayor Belle shared that she attended the Association of Washington Cities (AWC) Conference and this week she will attend the Summer Concert.

Mayor Bocchi spoke about attending the Association of Washington Cities (AWC) Conference and requested that the agendas be published earlier in the week to allow more time to review.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 8:55 p.m.



PAUL BOCCHI, MAYOR

ATTEST:



BRIANA SCHUMACHER
CITY CLERK